

LT Credit: Sensitive Land Protection

This credit applies to

- ▶ BD+C: New Construction (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Core and Shell (2 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Schools (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Retail (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Data Centers (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Warehouses and Distribution Centers (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Hospitality (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare (1 point)

INTENT

To cultivate community resilience, avoid the development of environmentally sensitive lands that provide critical ecosystem services and reduce the environmental impact from the location of a building on a site.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, SCHOOLS, RETAIL, DATA CENTERS, WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS, HOSPITALITY, HEALTHCARE

Option 1. Previously Developed Land

Locate the development footprint on land that has been *previously developed*.

OR

Option 2. Avoidance of Sensitive Land

Locate the development footprint on land that does not meet the following criteria for sensitive land:

- ▶ *Prime farmland*. Prime farmland, unique farmland, or farmland of statewide or local importance as defined by the U.S. Code of Federal Regulations, Title 7, Volume 6, Parts 400 to 699, Section 657.5 (or local equivalent for projects outside the U.S.) and identified in a state Natural Resources Conservation Service soil survey (or local equivalent for projects outside the U.S.).
- ▶ *Floodplains*. A flood hazard area shown on a legally adopted flood hazard map or otherwise legally designated by the local jurisdiction or the state. For projects in places without legally adopted flood hazard maps or legal designations, locate on a site that is entirely outside any floodplain subject to a 1% or greater chance of flooding in any given year.
- ▶ *Habitat*. Land identified as habitat for the following:
 - species listed as threatened or endangered under the U.S. Endangered Species Act or the state's endangered species act, or
 - species or ecological communities classified by NatureServe as GH (possibly extinct), G1 (critically imperiled), or G2 (imperiled), or
 - species listed as threatened or endangered species under local equivalent standards (for projects outside the U.S.) that are not covered by NatureServe data.
- ▶ *Water bodies*. Areas on or within 100 feet (30 meters) of a *water body*, except for minor improvements.
- ▶ *Wetlands*. Areas on or within 50 feet (15 meters) of a *wetland*, except for minor improvements.

GUIDANCE

There are no substantive changes to the credit requirements; refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following additions and modifications:

Behind the Intent

Beta Update

The two credit options were given titles to clarify their intent and remain consistent with the format of other credit options. The list of minor improvements within wetland and water body buffers has been moved from the rating system language to the guide because it is guidance.

Step-by-Step Guidance

- ▶ Option 1 can now be referenced as “Option 1. Previously Developed Land.”
- ▶ Option 2 can now be referenced as “Option 2. Avoidance of Sensitive Land.”

Further Explanation

Identifying Sensitive Habitat

- ▶ Minor improvements within the wetland and water body buffers may be undertaken to enhance appreciation of them, provided such facilities are open all building users. Only the following improvements are considered minor:
- ▶ Bicycle and pedestrian pathways no more than 12 feet wide (3.5 meters), of which no more than 8 feet (2.5 meters) may be impervious;
- ▶ Activities to maintain or restore native natural communities and/or natural hydrology;
- ▶ One single-story structure per 300 linear feet (90 linear meters) on average, not exceeding 500 square feet (45 square meters);
- ▶ Grade changes necessary to ensure public access;
- ▶ Clearings, limited to one per 300 linear feet (90 linear meters) on average, not exceeding 500 square feet (45 square meters) each;
- ▶ Removal of the following tree types:
- ▶ Hazardous trees, up to 75% of dead trees
- ▶ Trees less than 6 inches (150 millimeters) diameter at breast height
- ▶ Up to 20% of trees more than 6 inches (150 millimeters) diameter at breast height with a condition rating of 40% or higher.
- ▶ Trees under 40% condition rating
- ▶ The condition rating must be based on an assessment by an arborist certified by the International Society of Arboriculture (ISA) using ISA standard measures, or local equivalent for projects outside the U.S.
- ▶ For Option 3, Brownfield Remediation: Reference the US EPA’s National Priorities list as a resource.

Connection to Ongoing Performance

- ▶ LEED O+M SS credit Site Management: During an assessment, a project team may find features such as vegetation, land use, or hydrology that require protection to achieve this credit. The same assessment may be used to identify protection measures in the related credit.
- ▶ LEED O+M SS credit Rainwater Management: Sensitive land or previously undeveloped land on the project site that is left undisturbed may be used to manage runoff and help achieve the related credit.